

How Safe Is



Your Credit Card Explained

1. The credit card number can be broken into three parts:
 - a. System Number (Visa = 4; Mastercard = 5; etc.)
 - b. Bank Number (Bank Code)
 - c. Your Account number
 - d. The Check Code
2. The expiry date and name are also mentioned on the front
3. The Magnetic strip on the back contains information on your credit limit, bank details, ATM pin code, etc.
4. Some cards have a 3 or 4 digit verification PIN code on the reverse
5. The Signature strip helps prevent an unauthorised person from using your credit card offline.

Security

Most people do not realise that they themselves are the weakest link in the robust security chain of online transactions. Hackers cannot break gateway and bank level encryption—most will not even try. Your computer, however, might be a sitting duck, if you do not take the necessary precautions.

Threats

Worms / Trojans: You may be infected by worms or trojans. These email information from your computer to their creators—including credit card details.

Keyloggers: These log everything you type and e-mail it to a hacker

Spyware: Retrieves information from your computer and sends it to malicious sites

Solutions

To secure your computer, you should make sure you have a good anti-virus solution in place, such as Norton Antivirus, McAfee, PC-Cillin, etc. You should also install a good adware and spyware cleaner, such as AdAware or Spybot Search & Destroy. Finally, make sure you have all the latest critical updates for your OS